

YEAR 1 BUDGET

TURNING THE TIDES

FINANCIAL PLAN

FOUNDER: JOHN COLLINS
MAUI, HAWAII • A 501(C)(3) IN FORMATION
MAY 2026

Year 1 Overview

TOTAL YEAR 1 BUDGET

\$64,600

Founder serves as unpaid volunteer Year 1. 100% of donations reach veterans directly.

Category	Amount	% of Budget
Startup & Legal Costs	\$3,990	6.2%
Insurance & Compliance	\$4,800	7.4%
3 Pilot Retreats	\$37,800	58.5%
Operations & Admin (no founder stipend)	\$3,900	6.0%
Marketing & Development	\$5,700	8.8%
Contingency (15%)	\$8,429	13.1%
TOTAL	\$64,619	100%

Note: Founder John Collins serves as unpaid volunteer in Year 1. Founder compensation begins in Year 2, or earlier if Year 1 funding exceeds \$90,000.

How Funds Reach Veterans

More than 60% of every dollar goes directly toward retreat operations and veteran services. The remaining funds support the infrastructure, insurance, and personnel that make those retreats possible safely and at scale.

Cost Per Veteran Served

Year	Veterans Served	Cost per Veteran
Year 1 (Pilot — founder unpaid)	15	\$4,308
Year 3 (Scale — founder paid)	48	\$6,250
Year 5 (Mature)	72	\$6,944

For comparison, the VA spends approximately \$11,000 per year on outpatient PTSD care for a single veteran.

DETAILED LINE ITEMS

Startup & Compliance

Startup Costs

Line Item	Qty	Unit Cost	Total
501(c)(3) IRS Filing Fee	1	\$600	\$600
Hawaii Incorporation	1	\$50	\$50
EIN Application	1	\$0	\$0
Legal consultation (nonprofit setup)	5 hr	\$200	\$1,000
Bookkeeping software (QuickBooks)	12 mo	\$30	\$360
CPA review & setup	1	\$1,500	\$1,500
Website hosting & domain	12 mo	\$15	\$180
Logo / branding refinement	1	\$300	\$300
SUBTOTAL — STARTUP			\$3,990

Insurance & Compliance

Line Item	Qty	Unit Cost	Total
General Liability Insurance	12 mo	\$200	\$2,400
Directors & Officers (D&O)	12 mo	\$150	\$1,800
Participant Accident Coverage	12 mo	\$50	\$600
SUBTOTAL — INSURANCE			\$4,800

Insurance is non-negotiable. Without it, no liability protection for John, the board, or the program. Insurance quotes vary by state — Hawaii rates may differ. Get 2-3 quotes before locking in.

DETAILED LINE ITEMS

Per-Retreat Cost Breakdown

Each retreat hosts ~6 veterans for 7-14 days. Costs scale linearly — a 4-vet retreat is cheaper, an 8-vet retreat is more expensive.

Single Retreat (6 vets × 7 days)

Line Item	Qty	Unit Cost	Total
Round-trip flights to Maui	6	\$700	\$4,200
Ground transport on Maui	1	\$500	\$500
Lodging — <i>donated by partner</i>	42 nights	\$0	\$0
Groceries & meals	42 days	\$50	\$2,100
Surf instruction	6	\$150	\$900
Snorkel rental & guides	1	\$400	\$400
Hiking transport & permits	1	\$300	\$300
Cultural practitioner stipends	1	\$500	\$500
Park fees & permits	1	\$200	\$200
Facilitator stipend	1	\$2,000	\$2,000
Local helpers / volunteers	1	\$500	\$500
Farm supplies & gear	1	\$300	\$300
First aid / safety equipment	1	\$200	\$200
Per-retreat contingency	1	\$500	\$500
COST PER RETREAT			\$12,600

YEAR 1 TOTAL — 3 RETREATS

\$37,800

Approximately \$2,100 per veteran in direct retreat costs (lodging donated by partner)

DETAILED LINE ITEMS

Operations & Marketing

Operations & Personnel

Line Item	Qty	Unit Cost	Total
Founder / ED stipend — <i>deferred to Year 2</i>	—	\$0	\$0
Phone & internet	12 mo	\$100	\$1,200
Software subscriptions	12 mo	\$50	\$600
Office supplies & postage	1	\$500	\$500
Founder travel (mainland ↔ Maui)	2 trips	\$800	\$1,600
SUBTOTAL — OPERATIONS			\$3,900

Founder John Collins volunteers full-time in Year 1. Compensation begins Year 2, or once Year 1 funding exceeds \$90,000.

Marketing & Development

Line Item	Qty	Unit Cost	Total
Crowdfunding platform fees	1	\$500	\$500
Print materials (brochures, cards)	1	\$500	\$500
Photography / videography	2 days	\$750	\$1,500
Veteran outreach (events, conferences)	1	\$1,000	\$1,000
Social media boosted posts	12 mo	\$100	\$1,200
Donor cultivation events	2	\$500	\$1,000
SUBTOTAL — MARKETING			\$5,700

Contingency

15% of total budget held in reserve for unforeseen costs, emergency travel, equipment repair, or opportunity grants. Industry standard for early-stage nonprofits.

Year 1 Contingency Reserve	\$8,429
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Revenue Sources

Year 1 Funding Targets

Source	Probability	Target	Conservative
Foundation Grants	Medium	\$40,000	\$20,000
Individual Donations	High	\$20,000	\$10,000
Corporate Sponsorships	Medium	\$15,000	\$8,000
Crowdfunding Launch	High	\$15,000	\$10,000
Founder / Personal Capital	Confirmed	\$5,000	\$5,000
TOTAL		\$95,000	\$53,000

Specific Grant Targets

Grant Source	Focus	Range
Bob Woodruff Foundation	Veteran wellness	\$10k - \$50k
Gary Sinise Foundation	Veteran support	\$10k - \$25k
Semper Fi & America's Fund	Combat veterans	\$10k - \$30k
USDA Rural Development	Agriculture / rural	varies
Local Hawaii Foundations	Community-based	\$5k - \$20k

First-year nonprofits typically secure 40-60% of their target funding. The "Conservative" column above reflects a realistic worst-case scenario — even at this level, the program can run 2 retreats and serve 12 veterans.

LONG-TERM PROJECTION

5-Year Outlook

This projection assumes successful execution of Year 1, modest grant growth, and the addition of paid civilian wellness retreats as a revenue stream beginning in Year 2.

Year	Retreats	Veterans Served	Annual Budget	Revenue Goal
Year 1 (Pilot, founder unpaid)	3	15-18	\$64,600	\$95,000
Year 2 (Build)	5	30	\$200,000	\$220,000
Year 3 (Scale)	8	48	\$300,000	\$330,000
Year 4	10	60	\$400,000	\$440,000
Year 5 (Mature)	12	72	\$500,000	\$550,000
5-YEAR TOTAL	38	~225	\$1.51M	\$1.67M

Strategic Milestones

Year	Key Milestones
Year 1	501(c)(3) granted, 3 pilot retreats, board recruited, alumni network started
Year 2	Civilian wellness retreats launched, part-time program director hired, 3-month operating reserve achieved
Year 3	Permanent guest cabins built, full-time program staff, audited financials, signature annual fundraising event
Year 4	National alumni mentorship program, second retreat location explored
Year 5	Endowment fund established, 200+ veterans served lifetime, recognized as leading veteran retreat program in Hawaii

FOR DONORS & FUNDERS

Every Dollar Reaches A Veteran.

Turning the Tides is committed to transparency in every dollar spent. Annual financial reports will be published publicly. Audited financials beginning Year 3.

JOHN COLLINS

FOUNDER, TURNING THE TIDES

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